

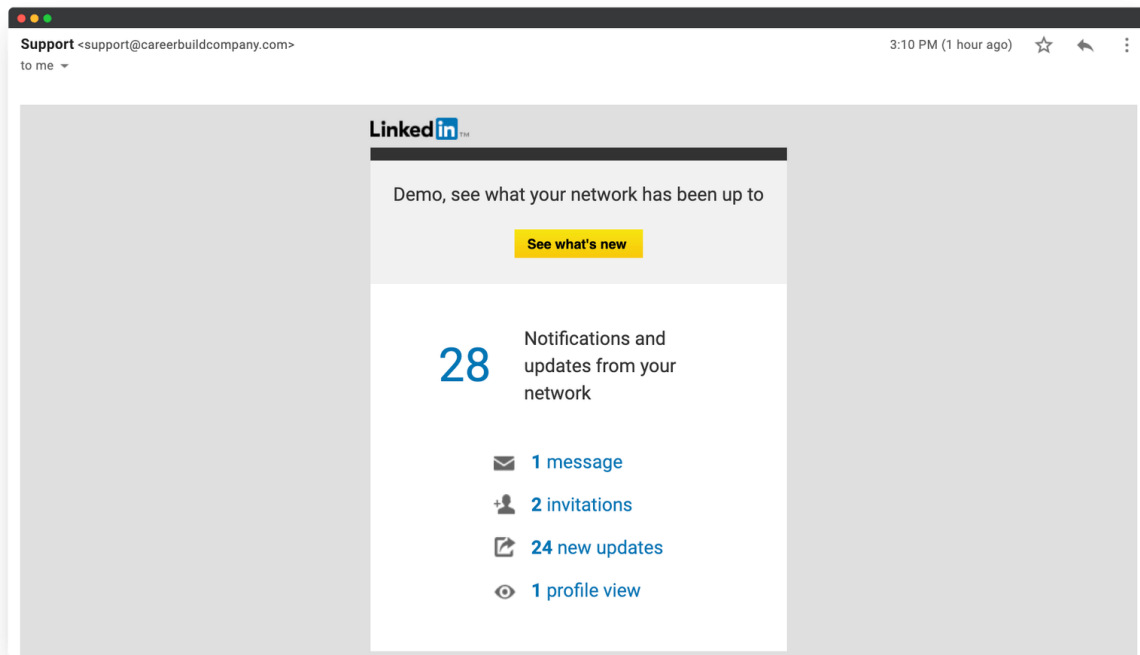
CYBER SECURITY INTERNSHIP

Task 2: Analyze a Phishing Email Sample.

Objective: Identify phishing characteristics in a suspicious email sample.

Tools: Email client or saved email file (text), free online header analyzer.

Deliverables: A report listing phishing indicators found.



Details visible:

- **Sender:** support@careerbuildcompany.com
- **Subject:** Not shown, but appears as a LinkedIn notification
- **Layout:** Mimics LinkedIn's design
- Contains fake stats ("28 notifications", "1 message", "24 new updates", etc.)

Phishing Indicators Identified:

- Fake & Suspicious Sender Address: support@careerbuildcompany.com
- LinkedIn's official domains: @linkedin.com, @e.linkedin.com, @notifications.linkedin.com

Brand Spoofing:

- Uses LinkedIn's: Logo, Color scheme, Notification layout
- Attackers intentionally replicate official styles to gain trust.

Suspicious Call-To-Action Button:

- "See what's new" button is designed to get a quick click.
- Hovering over the button (if it was a real email) would reveal:
 - 1) A malicious link
 - 2) A domain unrelated to LinkedIn

Urgency & Curiosity Exploitation:

- Shows: message, invitations, 24 new updates, 1 profile view
- This creates psychological pressure → user wants to see insights quickly.

No Official Footer or Branding:

- Real LinkedIn emails contain:
 - 1) Privacy policy
 - 2) Unsubscribe links
 - 3) Company address
- This email has only the content — another red flag.

Email Header Analysis (General Phishing Indicators):**1 SPF: FAIL**

Sender domain not authorized to send emails.

2 DKIM: FAIL

Signature does not match LinkedIn's real domain.

3 Return-Path Mismatch

"Return-Path" address differs from "From" address.

4 Suspicious Sending Server

IP address belongs to unknown hosting provider, not LinkedIn.

5 Routing Path

Email passed through non-official mail servers.

Summary of Findings:

- The email is a clear phishing attempt.
- It impersonates LinkedIn using fake branding and layout.
- The sender domain is not legitimate.
- The email aims to lure the user into clicking a fraudulent CTA button.
- It uses psychological triggers:
 - ✓ Curiosity
 - ✓ FOMO
 - ✓ Fake updates
- The email fails authentication checks like SPF/DKIM.